

The Orchard Below

Fictional Movie Catalog

2026

Catalog Metadata

Release date: May 8, 2026

Runtime: 111 minutes

Genres: Mystery, Drama

Director: Ruben Hale

Writer: Sofia Bell

Top cast: Leona Price as Mara Bell; Milo Saye as Owen Bell; Nora Wren as Elise Venn; Cal Danner as Thomas Bell.

Mock IMDb rating: 7.7 from 9,360 votes

Synopsis

After their father's death, estranged siblings Mara and Owen Bell return to the orchard where they grew up. A sinkhole opens beside the oldest pear tree and reveals a sealed observatory beneath the roots. Inside are weather journals, star charts, and recordings made by their mother, who vanished twenty years earlier.

The recordings describe a rare atmospheric phenomenon that makes distant sounds seem to come from beneath the ground. Mara believes the notebooks can explain their mother's disappearance, while Owen suspects their father used the story to hide a family crime. As an unseasonal frost threatens the harvest, they reconstruct the observatory's last experiment and uncover a choice their parents made to protect them.

Themes and Style

The mystery is grounded in family memory rather than the supernatural. The orchard changes with each discovery: bright spring rows gradually give way to fog, bare branches, and the blue light of the underground dome. The film focuses on grief, unreliable memory, forgiveness, and the difference between a secret kept for control and one kept out of love.

Production Notes

The orchard exteriors were filmed across four seasons and combined into a single fictional week. The observatory set used a hand-operated brass planetarium. The fictional production is rated PG for mature themes and mild peril.